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Have you ever asked yourself why something you are trusting God for is taking so long to happen? Have you been tempted to take the easy road out? Let the timeless story of Abraham bring you the profound consolation of God. The truth is that the world we live in is full of expectations. There is so much pressure around us to succeed. Pressure to have our problems fixed, to meet our goals, to achieve the next big thing, and the dreams we have deep within. Sometimes we envision miraculous breakthroughs – perhaps a large sum of money to pay off all our bills and solve every challenge we currently face. But what happens when the breakthrough is delayed? When we have prayed, fasted, worshipped, quoted scriptures, listened to sermons, attended every church service, and still nothing changes. That’s where many of us find ourselves: discouraged, discontented, and disillusioned. But wait, the scripture reminds us that we are not the first to feel this way.

Romans 15:4
For whatsoever things were written aforetime were written for our learning, that we through patience and comfort of the scriptures might have hope.

The truth is that there is nothing new under the sun. When we turn to the word of God, we find the stories of men and women who went through similar struggles. Remember, the Bible is not a book of perfect people; it is a book of real people facing real situations and meeting a real God who never fails. Let’s explore the story of Abraham, a man called by God and yet tested in ways we can relate to.

THE CALL AND THE DELAY

God called Abraham (then still named Abram) out of his father’s house to a new land that God would give him. In doing so, God promised to make him great:

Genesis 12:2
And I will make of thee a great nation, and I will bless thee, and make thy name great; and thou shalt be a blessing:

However, Abraham faced a significant problem: he was old and childless. When we move to **Genesis 15**, several years had passed, and Abraham still had no child. Seeing the delay, Abraham began to question God:

Genesis 15:2
And Abram said, LORD God, what wilt thou give me, seeing I go childless, and the steward of my house is this Eliezer of Damascus?

This was Abraham’s moment of disillusionment. He had heard the promise of God, believed it, and waited, but it wasn’t happening. Just like many of us, he started to wonder: “God, when will this happen? How can this ever happen?”

Abraham here was disillusioned, like some of us tend to be. When we began to hear God’s Word, we got excited as we discovered the glory that God has heaped for us in Christ. What glorious hopes and affirmations of righteousness, the indwelling of the Spirit, the fruit and gifts He bestows. Yet, our life experiences seem like a stark contrast to the glory-life the Word describes, and we soon become discouraged. Isn’t that how we feel sometimes? We start strong with faith, but when things delay, a second voice rises; one that contradicts what God said. That’s the tactic of the devil right from Genesis 3
Genesis 3:1-6
Now the serpent was more subtil than any beast of the field which the LORD God had made. And he said unto the woman, Yea, hath God said, Ye shall not eat of every tree of the garden?

2 And the woman said unto the serpent, We may eat of the fruit of the trees of the garden:
3 but of the fruit of the tree which is in the midst of the garden, God hath said, Ye shall not eat of it, neither shall ye touch it, lest ye die.
4 And the serpent said unto the woman, Ye shall not surely die:
5 for God doth know that in the day ye eat thereof, then your eyes shall be opened, and ye shall be as gods, knowing good and evil.
6 And when the woman saw that the tree was good for food, and that it was pleasant to the eyes, and a tree to be desired to make one wise, she took of the fruit thereof, and did eat, and gave also unto her husband with her; and he did eat.

This is where we start to feel like we should take matters into our own hands, do things, and act as if we are God to determine what is best for us.

WHAT TO DO INSTEAD

a. Believe in what God says Look at what God did
Genesis 15:4-6
And, behold, the word of the Lord came unto him, saying, This shall not be thine heir; but he that shall come forth out of thine own bowels shall be thine heir.
5 And he brought him forth abroad, and said, Look now toward heaven, and tell the stars, if thou be able to number them: and he said unto him, So shall thy seed be.
6 And he believed in the Lord; and he counted it to him for righteousness.

God reiterated his promise to Abraham. Even in his confusion, Abraham chose to believe God.
Genesis 15:6
And he believed in the LORD; and he counted it to him for righteousness. This is what God wants from us, not perfection, but faith. Faith that clings to His word even when everything else says otherwise.

b. Don’t yield to pressure
In Genesis 16, Abraham faced pressure from his wife, Sarah. She offered him her maid, Hagar, to have a child. Abraham agreed, and Ishmael was born. But that wasn’t God’s plan. Like us when things delay, we look for shortcuts or alternatives; maybe stop going to church, stop praying, stop feeding on the Word. But shortcuts never lead to God’s promise.

c. See yourself in light of who God has called you to be
Genesis 17:5
Neither shall thy name any more be called Abram, but thy name shall be Abraham; for a father of many nations have I made thee.
Genesis 17:15
And God said unto Abraham, As for Sarai thy wife, thou shalt not call her name Sarai, but Sarah shall her name be.

God revealed to Abraham and Sarah their identity and who he called them to be. He needed them to see themselves as He saw them. This is to show us that our identity matters when it comes to God and us fulfilling what God said we can fulfill. Take a moment and reflect: how do you see yourself? Know that the word of God has the power to change your identity; from discouraged to hopeful, from disillusioned to faith-filled, from discontented to grateful, from defeated to



victorious. When you begin to see yourself through the lens of God’s Word, everything starts to shift. You’re no longer a victim; you’re righteous, redeemed, forgiven, and called.

THE FULFILLMENT OF THE PROMISE

Finally, in Genesis 21, the promise came to pass. Isaac was born. The very thing that once seemed impossible, God made to happen.
Genesis 21:2
For Sarah conceived, and bare Abraham a son in his old age, at the set time of which God had spoken to him

This happened because Abraham believed. Even when he made mistakes, even when he doubted, he still came back to God’s word. So, what do you do when you’re discouraged, discontented, or disillusioned? You stay on God’s word. In the face of sickness, lack, pressure, temptation, sin, shame, guilt, or failure, don’t disconnect from God. Don’t step out of His Word. That’s the time to lock in and press for more. That’s the time to stay connected to fellowship, church, prayer, and his truth. Like Abraham, you may have your ‘Ishmael moments,” but that’s not the end. God’s word over your life will still come to pass. Stay in His Word. Let it shape how you think, see, and approach things. Let His Word define your identity. Let it renew your strength and hope. Just like Abraham, you will see the promise delivered in due time. No matter how things look, always remember that God’s Word hasn’t changed.